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Horse boot dryer

Abstract

The present invention relates to a horse boot dryer that includes a hanging tether that interconnects at both ends forming a drying loop. In operation, the drying loop can be hung from an elevated object. The horse boot dryer can comprise at least one boot holder rod and at least one tether cord. The tether cord connects at one end to the drying loop and connects at the other end to the boot holder rod. During use, the boot holder rod can be inserted through a horse boot and orientated to span the horse boot opening, preventing the horse boot from sliding off of the tether cord and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application contains subject matter which is related to the subject matter of the following co-pending application. The below-listed application is hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety: (2) This is a U.S. non-provisional application that claims the benefit of a U.S. provisional application, Ser. No. 63/462,553, inventor Ashley Wolchina Allison, entitled “HORSE BOOT DRYER”, filed Apr. 28, 2023.

TECHNICAL FIELD OF THE INVENTION
(1) This invention relates to a horse boot dryer and particularly to a hangable drying system in which horse boots can be slipped onto tethers and secured in position while drying.
BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION
(2) Before our invention, horse boots were commonly used on the legs of equine to protect them from injury. During the wearing of the boots, the boots are subject to exposure to dirt, water, perspiration from the horse, and other elements that then require the boots to be washed or otherwise dried before subsequent use. Such drying was accomplished by laying the boot on a surface. In this regard, the boots were not secured or elevated in a manner that would expedite the drying process.
(3) Prior fixed racks that attach to a wall have shortcomings that include being large and bulky and

not particularly useful for cleaning the boots. Additionally, they can be difficult to transport and reattach to a wall when needed.

(4) The present invention addresses these and other shortcomings by providing a horse boot dryer and other advantages. For these reasons and shortcomings as well as other reasons and shortcomings there is a long-felt need that gives rise to the present invention.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) The shortcomings of the prior art are overcome and additional advantages are provided through the provision of a horse boot dryer **100** that comprises a hanging tether that interconnects at both ends forming a drying loop. In operation, the drying loop can be hung from an elevated object. The horse boot dryer can comprise at least one boot holder rod and at least one tether cord. The tether cord connects at one end to the drying loop and connects at the other end to the boot holder rod. In operation, the boot holder rod can be inserted through a horse boot and orientated to span the horse boot opening, preventing the horse boot from sliding off of the tether cord and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.

(6) Additional shortcomings of the prior art are overcome and additional advantages are provided through the provision of a horse boot dryer **100** that comprises a ring, a latching fastener, and a hanging tether. One end of the hanging tether can be secured to the ring and the other end of the hanging tether can be secured to the latching fastener. The latching fastener and the ring interlock, in a removable manner, forming a drying loop. In operation, the drying loop can be hung from an elevated object. The horse boot dryer can further comprise at least one latching tether fastener, at least one boot holder rod, and at least one tether cord. One end of the tether cord can be secured to the latching tether fastener and the other end of the tether cord can be secured to the boot holder rod. The latching tether fastener interlocks, in a removable manner, and hangs from the drying loop. In operation, the boot holder rod passes through and is orientated to span a horse boot, preventing the horse boot from falling off the tether cord and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.

(7) Additional shortcomings of the prior art are overcome and additional advantages are provided through the provision of a horse boot dryer **100** that comprises a buckle, a receiver, and a hanging tether. One end of the hanging tether can be secured to the buckle and the other end of the hanging tether can be secured to the receiver. The buckle and the receiver interlock, in a removable manner, forming a drying loop, In operation, the drying loop can be hung from an elevated object. The horse boot dryer can further comprise at least one latching tether fastener, at least one boot holder rod, and at least one tether cord. One end of the tether cord can be secured to the latching tether fastener and the other end of the tether cord can be secured to the boot holder rod. The latching tether fastener interlocks, in a removable manner, and hangs from the drying loop. In operation, the boot holder rod passes through and is orientated to span the opening of a horse boot, preventing the horse boot from falling off the tether cord and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.

(8) Additional features and advantages are realized through the techniques of the present invention. Other embodiments and aspects of the invention are described in detail herein and are considered a part of the claimed invention. For a better understanding of the invention with advantages and features, refer to the description and the drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) The foregoing and other objects, features, and advantages of the invention are apparent from the following detailed description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings in which:

(2) FIG. **1** illustrates one example of a horse boot dryer;

(3) FIG. **2-5**. illustrate exemplary embodiments of a horse boot dryer; and
(4) FIG. **6** illustrates one example of a method of using a horse boot dryer.
(5) The detailed description explains the preferred embodiments of the invention, together with advantages and features, by way of example with reference to the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(6) Turning now to the drawings in greater detail, it will be seen that in FIG. **1** there is illustrated one example of a horse boot dryer **100**. In an exemplary embodiment, a horse boot dryer **100** can comprise a hanging tether **110** that interconnects at both ends **106**/**108** or **116**/**118** forming a drying loop **124**. In operation, the drying loop **124** can be hung from an elevated object **402**. Such elevated object **402**, as better illustrated in at least FIGS. **3**, **4**, and **5** can be a barn door, a beam, a horse stall, or other convenient location, as may be required and/or desired in a particular embodiment.
(7) In the present invention, the horse dryer **100** can be customized as to size and use variations such as small (pony boots), medium (regular horse boots), and large (very large or heavy boots) as required and/or desired in a particular embodiment. Additionally, the horse boot dryer **100** can be customized as to color combinations, hardware selection, monogram, and other suitable types and/or kinds of customizations, as may be required and/or desired in a particular embodiment.
(8) In an exemplary embodiment and as better illustrated in at least FIG. **2** reference ‘A’ a latching fastener **106** and a ring **108** can be attached to the ends of the hanging tether **110**. In this regard, latching fastener **106** and ring **108** can be interconnected, in a removable manner, to secure the hanging tether **110** around an elevated object **402** for use. Such a latching fastener can be a carabiner, slide bolt spring snap, or other suitable latching fastener.
(9) In another exemplary embodiment and as better illustrated in at least FIG. **2** references ‘C’ and ‘D’ a buckle **116** and a receiver **118** can be attached to the ends of the hanging tether **110**. In this regard, buckle **116** and receiver **118** can be interconnected, in a removable manner, to secure the hanging tether **110** around an elevated object **402** for use.
(10) In the present invention, an advantage is that washing and drying of the horse boots **202** can be easily accomplished while the horse boots **202** are hung in position. Additionally, the horse boots **202** can be washed, dried, and stored anywhere the horse boot dryer **100** can be hung. In the present invention, another advantage is that the horse boot dryer **100** easily folds up for transport, occupies minimal space, and hangs up in seconds at a new location when needed.
(11) In an exemplary embodiment, there can be more than one tether cord **102** and more than one boot holder rod **104**. Each of the tether cords **102** connects at one end to the hanging tether **110** and at the other end to the boot holder rod **104**. During use, the boot holder rod **104** can be inserted through a horse boot **202** and orientated to span the horse boot **202** opening **204**, preventing the horse boot **202** from sliding off of the tether cord **102**.
(12) In an exemplary embodiment and as better illustrated in at least FIG. **2** reference ‘B’ and FIG. **4**, the tether cord **102** can be looped **128** at one end so that the hanging tether **110** can pass through securing the tether cord **102** to the hanging tether **110** in a movable manner. A fastener **126** can be used to secure the tether cord **102** to itself, forming and maintaining the loop **128** at one end, as may be required and/or desired in a particular embodiment.
(13) In an exemplary embodiment and as better illustrated in at least FIG. **1**, latching tether fastener **112** can be attached to the end of the tether cord **102** and the latching tether fastener **112** can be interconnected, in a removable manner, to and hang from the drying loop **124**.
(14) The tether cord **102** can be made from a stretchable (shock cord style) material, non-stretchable materials, cords, or other suitable materials. The boot holder rod **104** can lightweight and be made from plastic, wood, metal, a combination thereof, or other suitable material. Additionally, the boot holder rods **104** width **130** can be circular, square, flat, or other suitable shape, and the length **132** of the boot holder rods **104** can be in the range of several inches selected to easily span the open **204** of the horse boot **202**. In general, the boot holder rods **104** can have variable diameters and/or dimensions depending on use such as small, medium, large, and other

sizes.
(15) In an exemplary embodiment, instead of latching fastener **106** and ring **108**, the hanging tether **110** can comprise a buckle **106** at one end and a receiver **108** at the other end. The buckle **116** and the receiver **118** interconnect to form the drying loop **124** that can be hung from an elevated object **402**.
(16) Referring to FIG. **2**, there are illustrated exemplary embodiments of a horse boot dryer **100**.
(17) In an exemplary embodiment and with reference to FIG. **2** reference ‘A’, the horse boot dryer **100** can comprise a ring **108**, and a latching fastener **106**. One end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to ring **108** and the other end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to the latching fastener **106**. The latching fastener **106** and ring **108** can be interlocked, in a removable manner, forming the drying loop **124**.
(18) In an exemplary embodiment and with reference to FIG. **2** reference ‘C’, a horse boot dryer **100** can comprise a buckle **116**, a receiver **118**, and a hanging tether **110**. One end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to buckle **116** and the other end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to receiver **118**. The buckle **116** and the receiver **118** interlock, in a removable manner, forming a drying loop **124**, In operation, the drying loop **124** can be hung from an elevated object **402**. The horse boot dryer **100** can further comprise at least one latching tether fastener **112**, at least one boot holder rod **104**, and at least one tether cord **102**. One end of the tether cord **112** can be secured to the latching tether fastener **112** and the other end of the tether cord **102** can be secured to the boot holder rod **104**. The latching tether fastener **112** interlocks, in a removable manner, and hangs from the drying loop **124**. In operation, the boot holder rod **104** passes through and is orientated to span a horse boot **202**, preventing the horse boot **202** from falling off the tether cord **102**, and allowing the horse boot **202** to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer **100**.
(19) In an exemplary embodiment and with reference to FIG. **2** reference ‘C’, the horse boot dryer **100** can comprise a buckle **116**, and a receiver **118**. One end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to the buckle **116** and the other end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to the receiver **118**. The buckle **116** and the receiver **118** interlock, in a removable manner, forming the drying loop **124**.
(20) In an exemplary embodiment and with reference to FIG. **2** reference ‘D’ and **3**, the boot holder rod **104** can have a hole **122** therethrough. The tether cord **102** can be attached to the boot holder rod **104** by passing through hole **122** and knotting, bead tieing, or crimping **114** to itself, preventing the tether cord **102** from being pulled back through hole **122**. In addition, hole **122** can be centrally located along the length of the boot holder rod **104**, or positioned at other suitable locations as may be required and/or desired in a particular embodiment.
(21) In an alternative embodiment, the tether cord **102** can be integrally formed into the boot holder rod **104** at one end.
(22) In an exemplary embodiment, a raised ridge end cap **120** can be formed on each end of the boot holder rod **104**. In operation, the raised ridge end cap **120** can prevent the horse boot **202** from sliding off one end of the boot holder rod **104**. In this regard, the horse boot **202** can nest on the boot holder rod **104** in between the raised ridge end caps **120** preventing the horse boot **202** from sliding off the boot holder rod **104** and falling from the horse boot dryer **100**.
(23) Referring to FIGS. **3-5**, there are illustrated exemplary embodiments of a horse boot dryer. In an exemplary embodiment, a horse boot dryer **100** can comprise a hanging tether **110** that interconnects at both ends forming a drying loop **124**. In operation, the drying loop **124** can be hung from an elevated object **402**. The horse boot dryer **100** can comprise at least one boot holder rod **104**, and at least one tether cord **102**. The tether cord **102** connects at one end to the drying loop **124** and connects at the other end to the boot holder rod **104**. In operation, the boot holder rod **104** can be inserted through a horse boot **202** and orientated to span the horse boot opening **204**, preventing the horse boot **202** from sliding off of the tether cord **102** and allowing the horse boot **202** to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer **100**.

(24) In an exemplary embodiment and with reference to FIGS. **1** and **5**, at least one latching tether fastener **112** can be secured to one end of the tether cord **102**. The latching tether fastener **112** can be interconnected, in a removable manner, to and hang from the drying loop **124**.
(25) Referring to FIG. **5**, in an exemplary embodiment, a horse boot dryer **100** can comprise a ring **108**, a latching fastener **106**, and a hanging tether **110**. One end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to ring **108** and the other end of the hanging tether **110** can be secured to the latching fastener **106**. The latching fastener **106** and the ring **108** interlocks, in a removable manner, forming a drying loop **124**. In operation, the drying loop **124** can be hung from an elevated object **402**. The horse boot dryer **100** can further comprise at least one latching tether fastener **112**, at least one boot holder rod **104**, and at least one tether cord **102**. One end of the tether cord **102** can be secured to the latching tether fastener **112** and the other end of the tether cord **102** can be secured to the boot holder rod **104**. The latching tether fastener **112** interlocks, in a removable manner, and hangs from the drying loop **124**. In operation, the boot holder rod **104** passes through and is orientated to span the opening of a horse boot **202**, preventing the horse boot **202** from falling off the tether cord **102**, and allowing the horse boot **202** to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer **100**.
(26) Referring to FIG. **6**, there is illustrated one example of a method of using a horse boot dryer **100**. In an exemplary embodiment, the method begins in step **1002** by interconnecting both ends of the hanging tether **110** to form the drying loop **124**.
(27) The method then continues in step **1004** by hanging the drying loop **124** from the elevated object **402**, and in step **1006** by passing one of the boot holder rods **104** through one of the horse boots **202**.
(28) The method then continues in step **1008** by orientating the horse boot rod **104** to span the opening **204** of the horse boot **202**, preventing the horse boot **202** from sliding off of the tether cord **102**, in step **1010** returning to the step of hanging for each of the horse boots **202** a user **502** desires to hang, and in step **1012** allowing the horse boots **202** to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer **100**.
(29) While the preferred embodiment of the invention has been described, it will be understood that those skilled in the art, both now and in the future, may make various improvements and enhancements.

Claims

1. A method of drying a horse boot using a horse boot dryer, the method comprising: interconnecting both ends of a hanging tether to form a drying loop, the hanging tether configured to be hung from an elevated object; hanging the drying loop from the elevated object; securing at least one tether cord at one end to the drying loop; securing the other end of the at least one tether cord to at least one boot holder rod; passing the at least one boot holder rod through the horse boot; orienting the at least one boot holder rod to span an opening of the horse boot to prevent the horse boot from sliding off the at least one tether cord; returning to the step of securing at least one tether cord at one end to the drying loop, for each horse boot a user desires to dry; and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.
2. The method in accordance with claim 1, further comprising: a buckle; and a receiver, wherein one end of the hanging tether is secured to the buckle and the other end is secured to the receiver, the buckle and the receiver being configured to interlock in a removable manner to form the drying loop with the hanging tether.
3. The method in accordance with claim 1, further comprising: a ring; and latching fastener, wherein one end of the hanging tether is secured to the ring and the other end is secured to the latching fastener, the latching fastener and the ring being configured to interlock in a removable manner to form the drying loop with the hanging tether.
4. The method in accordance with claim 1, further comprising: at least one latching tether fastener,

the at least one latching tether fastener is secured to one end of the at least one tether cord, and the at least one latching tether fastener interconnects with the drying loop, in a removable manner, to hang the at least one tether cord from the drying loop.
5. The method in accordance with claim 4, wherein the at least one latching tether fastener comprises a spring clip, hook, or carabiner configured to removably attach the at least one tether cord to the drying loop.
6. The method in accordance with claim 1, wherein the at least one boot holder rod having a hole therethrough, the at least one tether cord is attached to the at least one boot holder rod by passing through the hole and knotting, bead tying, or crimping to itself, preventing the at least one tether cord from being pulled back through the hole.
7. The method in accordance with claim 6, wherein the hole is centrally located along the length of the at least one boot holder rod.
8. The method in accordance with claim 1, further comprising: a raised ridge end cap is formed on each end of the at least one boot holder rod, wherein the raised ridge end cap prevents the horse boot from sliding off the end of the at least one boot holder rod.
9. The method in accordance with claim 1, wherein the at least one tether cord is made from a stretchable material.
10. The method in accordance with claim 1, wherein the at least one boot holder rod is made from plastic, wood, metal, or a combination thereof.
11. The method in accordance with claim 1, wherein the at least one tether cord comprises an adjustable length configured to vary a hanging height of the boot holder rod relative to the drying loop.
12. A method of drying a horse boot using a horse boot dryer having a ring and a latching fastener, the method comprising: interconnecting one end of a hanging tether to the ring and the other end to the latching fastener to form a drying loop, wherein the latching fastener and the ring interlock in a removable manner, and the drying loop is configured to be hung from an elevated object; hanging the drying loop from the elevated object; securing at least one tether cord at one end to a latching tether fastener; securing the other end of the at least one tether cord to at least one boot holder rod; removably connecting the latching tether fastener to the drying loop; passing the at least one boot holder rod through the horse boot; orienting the at least one boot holder rod to span an opening of the horse boot to prevent the horse boot from sliding off the at least one tether cord; returning to the step of securing at least one tether cord at one end to the latching tether fastener, for each horse boot a user desires to dry; and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.
13. The method in accordance with claim 12, wherein the at least one boot holder rod having a hole therethrough, the at least one tether cord is attached to the at least one boot holder rod by way of passing through the hole and knotting, bead tying, or crimping to itself, preventing the at least one tether cord from being pulled back through the hole.
14. The method in accordance with claim 13, wherein the hole is centrally located along the length of the at least one boot holder rod.
15. The method in accordance with claim 12, further comprising: a raised ridge end cap is formed on each end of the at least one boot holder rod, wherein the raised ridge end cap prevents the horse boot from sliding off the end of the at least one boot holder rod.
16. The method in accordance with claim 12, wherein the at least one boot holder rod is made from plastic, wood, metal, or a combination thereof.
17. The method in accordance with claim 12, wherein the at least one boot holder rod is configured to nest the horse boot between two raised ridge end caps formed on opposing ends of the boot holder rod.
18. A method of drying a horse boot using a horse boot dryer having a buckle and a receiver, the method comprising: interconnecting one end of a hanging tether to the buckle and the other end to the receiver to form a drying loop, wherein the buckle and the receiver interlock in a removable

manner, and the drying loop is configured to be hung from an elevated object; hanging the drying loop from the elevated object; securing at least one tether cord at one end to a latching tether fastener; securing the other end of the at least one tether cord to at least one boot holder rod; removably connecting the latching tether fastener to the drying loop; passing the at least one boot holder rod through the horse boot; orienting the at least one boot holder rod to span the opening of the horse boot to prevent the horse boot from sliding off the at least one tether cord; returning to the step of securing at least one tether cord at one end to the latching tether fastener, for each horse boot a user desires to dry; and allowing the horse boot to hang and dry from the horse boot dryer.

19. The method in accordance with claim 18, further comprising: a raised ridge end cap is formed on each end of the at least one boot holder rod, wherein the raised ridge end cap prevents the horse boot from sliding off the end of the at least one boot holder rod.

20. The method in accordance with claim 18, wherein the at least one tether cord is secured to the drying loop using a looped end and a fastener to maintain the loop.
